

scripts/distribute-api-remote.sh

— User Guide

Last verified: 2026-05-15 (1.2.23 closure-cycle, §6.AD-debt task #61 backfill) **Inheritance:** HelixConstitution §11.4.18 (script documentation mandate)

Overview

Stub doc generated from the script's in-source header comment. See scripts/distribute-api-remote.sh for canonical behavior. This stub exists so the CM-SCRIPT-DOCS-SYNC pre-push gate (.githubhooks/pre-push Check 9) starts gating modifications to this script.

The script's own header documentation (verbatim):

```
scripts/distribute-api-remote.sh — distribute lava-api-go to a
remote host.
```

Usage:

```
./scripts/distribute-api-remote.sh                                #
default: thinker.local
./scripts/distribute-api-remote.sh another-host.local
```

The remote host MUST:

- Be reachable via SSH at \$LAVA_REMOTE_HOST_USER@\$REMOTE_HOST
- Have passwordless SSH (key-based auth) configured
- Have rootless Podman 4.x or later installed

What it does:

1. Loads .env (LAVA_REMOTE_HOST_USER, optional overrides).
2. Verifies SSH connectivity to the target host.
3. Builds the lava-api-go OCI image if releases/<version>/api-go/
lava-api-go-<v>.image.tar is missing.
4. Copies the OCI image tarball + thinker.local.env + thinker-up.sh
+ TLS certs to the remote host.
5. Runs deployment/thinker/thinker-up.sh on the remote.
6. Verifies https://\$REMOTE_HOST:\$PORT/health responds.

Inverse: `scripts/distribute-api-remote.sh --tear-down <host>` stops
+ removes
the remote containers + image (used at the end of this session to
free
the local host of all API containers + images).

Constitutional bindings:

- §6.H – credentials never logged; `.env` is gitignored.
- §6.J – `set -euo pipefail`; no ``|| echo WARN`` swallow.
- §6.B – health check is a real HTTP probe, not just ``podman ps``.
- §6.M – no host power-management commands; rootless Podman.

Usage

See the script's in-source comment block (above) for canonical usage examples.

Maintenance

When this script is modified, update this document in the same commit (CM-SCRIPT-DOCS-SYNC requires it). Per §11.4.18, the documentation MUST stay in sync with the codebase — no doc may be out of sync with its script.

Cross-references

- `scripts/distribute-api-remote.sh` — the script itself
- `docs/helix-constitution-gates.md` — gate inventory
- `HelixConstitution Constitution.md` §11.4.18 (the mandate)
- `Lava CLAUDE.md` §6.AD (HelixConstitution Inheritance)